Source sheets

Reading records, remembering violence | v21.0

Use these sheets with the student worksheet. A historical record establishes some claims and leaves others open. Page-image readings may be provisional. You are not required to infer motives, name perpetrators or disclose family experiences.

A · 1860 census, Spencer Horner household (S01)

Government population schedule; Mulberry Township, Johnson County, Arkansas; Clarksville post office; heading 20 June 1860. Dwelling 698, family 699, lines 1–7. Extracted unaltered from page 1 of the owner-supplied “1860 census” export. Original series/roll and provider image identifier remain to be reconciled. The page heading has differing handwritten page numbers and stamped 1029.

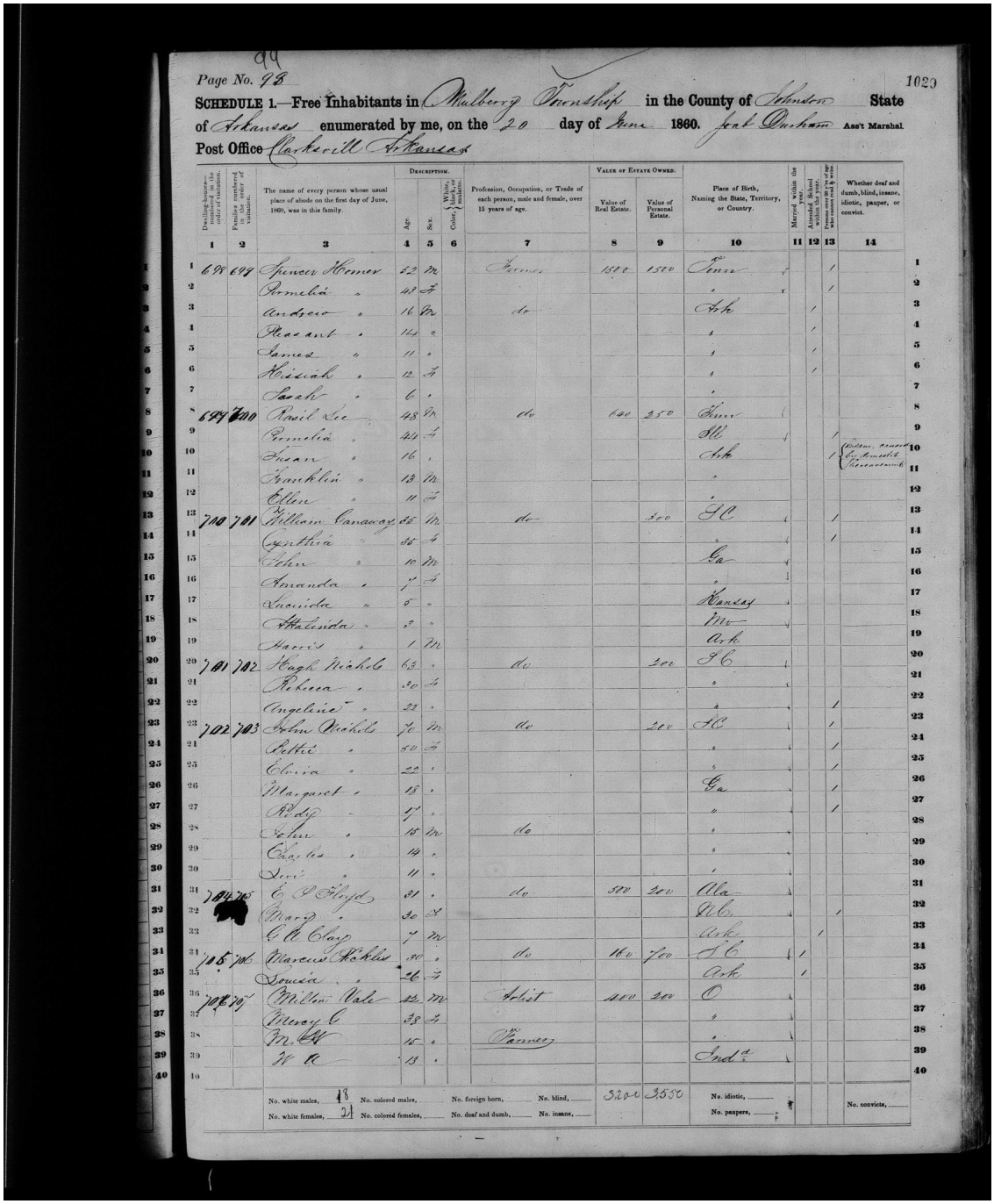
Reading aid: Spencer Horner, 52, farmer, Tennessee; real estate $1,500, personal estate $1,500. Permelia is listed on line 2. Other names and ages are provisional; the full cautious transcription is in the source catalog. This schedule does not explicitly state household relationships. It does not establish motives, cash hidden, or acreage. The next page is the full record image, so you can check rather than rely only on this aid.

B · Federal land patent (S02)

Patent 19B, 1 April 1857, Fayetteville Land Office; repository image, original accession pending. Spencer Horner appears as assignee of Co-cha-tubbee, representative of Canne Chubbee, deceased. Total 160 acres: SE 1/4 NE 1/4 and NW 1/4 SE 1/4 of section 19; NW 1/4 NW 1/4 and SE 1/4 NW 1/4 of section 22; T12N R24W. It does not establish Horner ancestry, a transfer price, an attacker’s motive, or a modern house site. Facsimile follows the census page.

A · Full census page

Source S01 · top household, lines 1–7 · Reading aid on preceding sheet.



Page No. 99 — 1023

SCHEDULE 1.—Free Inhabitants in Mulberry Township in the County of Johnson State of Arkansas enumerated by me, on the 20 day of June 1860. Joel Durham Ass't Marshal

Post Office Clarksville Arkansas

Dwelling-houses—numbered in the order of visitation.	Families numbered in the order of visitation.	The name of every person whose usual place of abode on the first day of June, 1860, was in this family.	Age.	Sex.	Color, black, or mulatto.	Profession, Occupation, or Trade of each person, male and female, over 15 years of age.	Value of Estate Owned. Value of Real Estate.	Value of Personal Estate.	Place of Birth, Naming the State, Territory, or Country.	Married within the year.	Attended School within the year.	Persons over 20 years of age who cannot read & write.	Whether deaf and dumb, blind, insane, idiotic, pauper, or convict.
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14
698	698	Spencer Horner	52	M		Farmer	1500	1500	Tenn			1	
		Pamelia "	48	F					"			1	
		Andrew "	16	M		do			Ark		1		
		Pleasant "	14	"					"		1		
		James "	11	"					"		1		
		Hiziah "	12	F					"		1		
		Sarah "	6	"					"				
699	699	Basil Lee	48	M		do	600	250	Tenn				
		Pamelia "	41	F					Ill			1	
		Susan "	16	"					Ark			1	Deaf, dumb & Convicted of Manslaughter
		Franklin "	13	M					"				
		Ellen "	11	F					"				
700	701	William Conaway	55	M		do		500	SC			1	
		Cynthia "	38	F					"			1	
		Ethen "	10	M					Ga				
		Amanda "	7	F					"				
		Lucinda "	5	"					Kansas				
		Atalanda "	3	"					Mo				
		Harris "	1	M					Ark				
701	702	Hugh Nichols	63	"		do		200	SC				
		Rebecca "	50	F					"				
		Angeline "	22	"					"			1	
702	703	John Nichols	70	M		do		200	SC			1	
		Lettie "	50	F					"			1	
		Elvira "	22	"					"			1	
		Margaret "	18	"					Ga			1	
		Reddy "	17	"					"			1	
		John "	15	M		do			"				
		Charles "	14	"					"				
		Levi "	11	"					"				
704	705	E. D. Floyd	31	"		do	500	200	Ala				
		Mary "	30	F					Ala			1	
		C. A. Clay	7	M					Ark		1		
705	706	Marcus Nichols	30	"		do	1100	700	SC	1			
		Louisa "	26	F					Ark		1		
706	707	Milton Vale	42	M		Artist	400	200	O				
		Mercy C.	38	F					"				
		M. H.	15	"		Farmer			"				
		W. A.	13	"					Ind.				
							3200	3550					

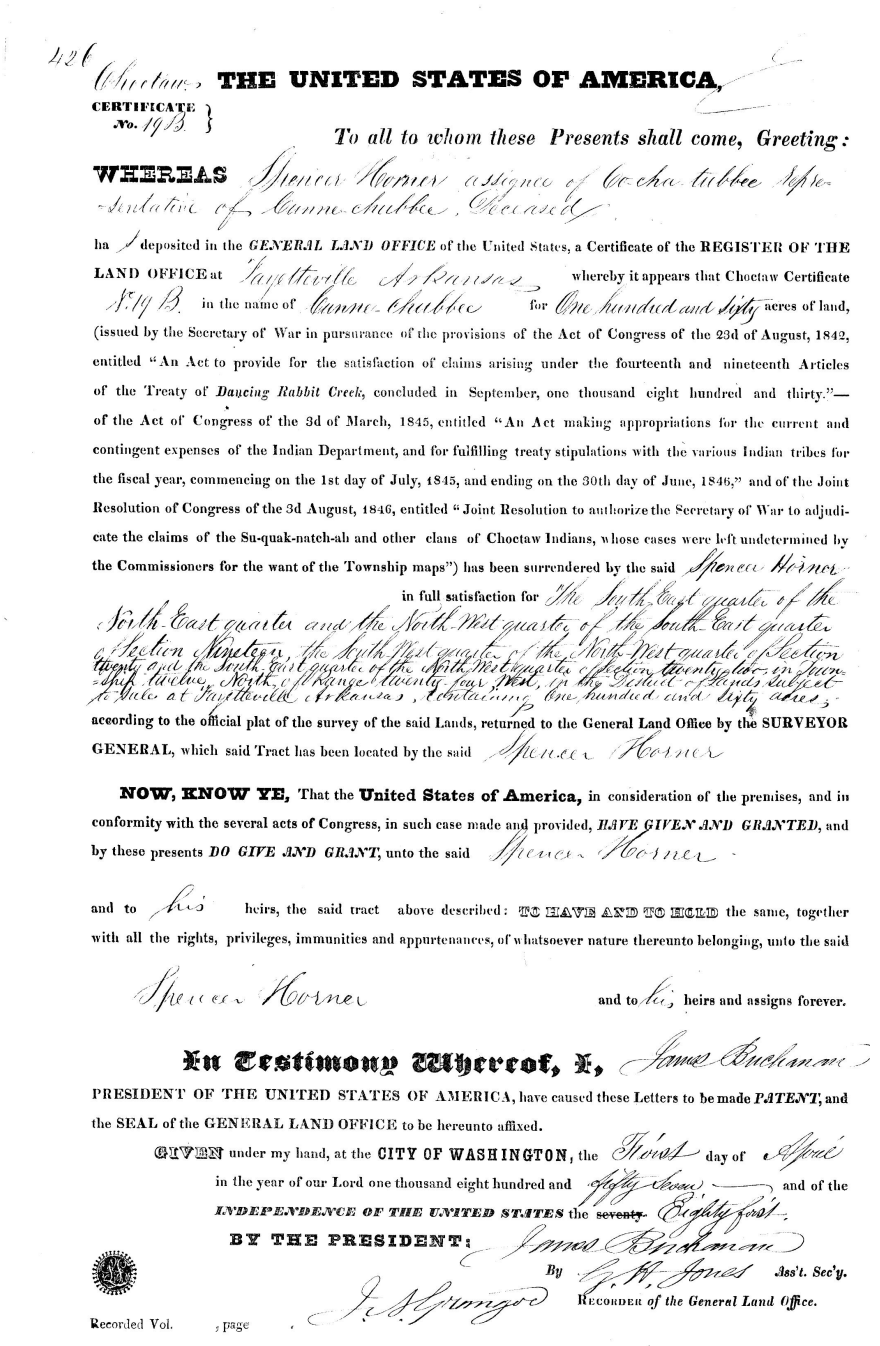
No. white males, 13 No. colored males, ____ No. foreign born, ____ No. blind, ____

No. white females, 21 No. colored females, ____ No. deaf and dumb, ____ No. insane, ____

No. idiotic, ____ No. paupers, ____ No. convicts, ____

B · Patent 19B

Source S02 · 1 April 1857 · Read the tract descriptions, not a modern map.



426 Choctaw

THE UNITED STATES OF AMERICA,

CERTIFICATE No. 1913

To all to whom these Presents shall come, Greeting:

WHEREAS Spencer Horner assignee of Cochuhubbee Representative of Cunnechubbee, Deceased

has deposited in the *GENERAL LAND OFFICE* of the United States, a Certificate of the REGISTER OF THE LAND OFFICE at Fayetteville Arkansas whereby it appears that Choctaw Certificate No. 19 B. in the name of Cunnechubbee for One hundred and Sixty acres of land, (issued by the Secretary of War in pursuance of the provisions of the Act of Congress of the 23d of August, 1842, entitled "An Act to provide for the satisfaction of claims arising under the fourteenth and nineteenth Articles of the Treaty of *Dancing Rabbit Creek*, concluded in September, one thousand eight hundred and thirty."— of the Act of Congress of the 3d of March, 1845, entitled "An Act making appropriations for the current and contingent expenses of the Indian Department, and for fulfilling treaty stipulations with the various Indian tribes for the fiscal year, commencing on the 1st day of July, 1845, and ending on the 30th day of June, 1846," and of the Joint Resolution of Congress of the 3d August, 1846, entitled "Joint Resolution to authorize the Secretary of War to adjudicate the claims of the Su-quak-natch-ah and other clans of Choctaw Indians, whose cases were left undetermined by the Commissioners for the want of the Township maps") has been surrendered by the said Spencer Horner in full satisfaction for The South East quarter of the North East quarter and the North West quarter of the South East quarter of Section Nineteen, the North West quarter of the North West quarter of Section twenty and the South East quarter of the North West quarter of Section twenty-two in Township twelve North of Range twenty four West, in the District of Lands subject to Sale at Fayetteville Arkansas, containing One hundred and Sixty acres; according to the official plat of the survey of the said Lands, returned to the General Land Office by the SURVEYOR GENERAL, which said Tract has been located by the said Spencer Horner

NOW, KNOW YE, That the **United States of America,** in consideration of the premises, and in conformity with the several acts of Congress, in such case made and provided, *HAVE GIVEN AND GRANTED*, and by these presents *DO GIVE AND GRANT*, unto the said Spencer Horner

and to his heirs, the said tract above described: TO HAVE AND TO HOLD the same, together with all the rights, privileges, immunities and appurtenances, of whatsoever nature thereunto belonging, unto the said

Spencer Horner and to his heirs and assigns forever.

In Testimony Whereof, I, James Buchanan

PRESIDENT OF THE UNITED STATES OF AMERICA, have caused these Letters to be made *PATENT*, and the SEAL of the GENERAL LAND OFFICE to be hereunto affixed.

GIVEN under my hand, at the **CITY OF WASHINGTON**, the Firſt day of April in the year of our Lord one thousand eight hundred and Fifty Seven and of the *INDEPENDENCE OF THE UNITED STATES* the ~~seventy~~ Eighty first.

BY THE PRESIDENT: James Buchanan

By J. W. Jones Ass't. Sec'y.

J. S. Wrongo

RECORDER *of the General Land Office.*

Recorded Vol. , page ,

C and D · Commemoration and memory

C · William Riley Horner marker (S03)

Reading of the visible repository photograph: William Riley’s marker gives a death date of **10 August 1864** and says he was killed by parties known to his family. The installation date, photographer, photograph date and reproduction permission are unknown. The photograph is not reproduced in this pack. This is a reading aid, not a facsimile or certified diplomatic transcription. The repository image can be consulted separately if appropriate.

The wording records a memorial accusation. It does not name the killers or establish whether officials investigated. It does not prove a 2 August attack date. What could a court docket, inquest, or dated military record add?

D · Family account attributed to 1942 (S04)

Attributed paraphrase of published excerpts: the account describes Spencer surrendering and being shot, William receiving a head wound, and a later reprisal group associated with Dr. John Turner Horner. It reports seventeen of twenty attackers killed in reprisals. The published excerpt describes Jess Wilson holding the group’s horses.

These are statements attributed to a later family account. The complete manuscript, date/authorship and transmission chain have not been verified. The casualty count, identities and chronology are not independently corroborated here. This short paraphrase avoids graphic detail and is not presented as the original transcript. What would you need before treating two retellings as independent testimony?

Comparison prompt

Mark the event date, source date and unknown date for each sheet. Explain which claim each source can establish. Compare an attributed memory to an administrative record without assuming either answers every question.

Student worksheet: what does the record establish?

Class/date: _____ Student identifier chosen by teacher: _____

1. Read two sources

Question	Source __	Source __
Who made it, and for what purpose?		
Event date / document date / unknown dates?		
One statement you can observe directly?		
One tempting claim it cannot establish?		

2. Classify and explain

For each, mark **directly supported**, **inference**, **family-account claim**, or **unresolved**; identify your source.

1. The census heading says Mulberry Township. _____
2. The patent proves Spencer’s Indigenous ancestry. _____
3. William’s 10 August death inscription establishes an attack on 2 August. _____
4. A family account reports seventeen reprisal deaths. _____
5. No investigation happened because no investigation record has been located. _____

3. Write a museum label

Use 100–150 words, two source references, one clear uncertainty, and a record you would look for next. If you cannot read a word, mark it uncertain rather than inventing a reading.

Exit response

One difference between an event date and a document date: _____

One claim I changed after checking a source: _____

One specific next record and the question it could answer: _____

Reading records, remembering violence

Horner Civil War Archive | v21.0 | Grades 9–12 and adult learners | 50 minutes

This is an unpiloted classroom prototype. It makes no claim of meeting a particular grant’s minimum page requirement or a state standards code. A classroom teacher should confirm curricular fit, accessibility and local policy before use. The core activity works offline with the accompanying source pack; internet and cemetery visits are not required.

Learning goals

Students will (1) identify a source’s maker, date and purpose; (2) distinguish a directly observable statement from an inference; (3) cite two sources without treating them as independent proof of every claim; and (4) propose a record that could resolve a specific uncertainty. Evidence is assessed, not family identity or personal disclosure.

Preparation and access

Print the source sheets A–D and student worksheet. Provide large-print text or a digital copy; pair a student who needs image-reading support with the supplied partial transcription. Historical handwriting need not be decoded perfectly to complete the task. Images of government records are included; the privately made marker photograph is linked for optional study, not reproduced without established permission. Give the brief content notice: the lesson discusses two reported wartime killings without graphic injury details. Students may use the patent/census comparison instead of the death/memory comparison and meet the same goals.

Sequence

Time	Teacher action	Student product
0–5	Ask: What can one historical document prove? Explain direct statement vs inference.	One baseline claim classification
5–10	Introduce Johnson County and the difference between event date, document date and memorial date. Do not treat current site coordinates as verified.	Three date labels
10–25	Pairs compare A (census) and B (patent), using printed images and reading aids.	Two supported statements, one limit per source
25–35	Compare C (marker reading) and D (later family account), or continue A/B alternative.	Explain why 10 August death does not establish 2 August attack
35–45	Write a 100–150 word label using two sources and an explicit uncertainty.	Completed worksheet
45–50	Exit question and anonymous feedback.	Evidence-based next research step

Essential questions

How do land records, census entries, memorials and family narratives preserve different parts of the past? What does an inscription saying killers were known to the family establish? Which records would be needed to assess investigation or prosecution? Why is the absence of a located record different from proof that an event never happened?

Teacher key and acceptable answers

A: The heading reads Mulberry Township. Spencer is entered at age 52, with $1,500 in each property column. The census does not name attackers, state a motive or quantify acreage; relationship to Permelia needs corroborating evidence beyond schedule structure. Accept uncertainty on handwriting rather than penalizing it.

B: Patent date 1 April 1857; total 160 acres. First tract is SE 1/4 NE 1/4, section 19. Assignee status does not establish Horner ancestry or transfer price. A deed/assignment instrument is an appropriate next source.

C: The published marker reading gives William's death as 10 August 1864 and says those responsible were known to his family. It does not give their names or demonstrate official inaction. A dated court docket, indictment, inquest, correspondence or complete service card could address a narrower question. Record the marker's installation and photograph dates as unknown.

D: The account is attributed to 1942, long after 1864. It preserves a family narrative about surrender, a head wound and reprisals. Seventeen-of-twenty is attributed oral tradition, not an independently verified count. A full manuscript and transmission history are needed before claiming exact date, authorship or independence.

Example label: "An 1860 census page lists Spencer Horner in Mulberry Township, with reported real and personal estate of $1,500 each. A marker photograph gives William Riley Horner's death as 10 August 1864 and records a family accusation about the killers. These records describe property and commemoration; they do not explain the attackers' motives or establish what officials did. The attack date of 2 August needs separately dated evidence." Accept equally careful alternatives using any two sheets.

Worksheet classification key: 1 directly supported by A; 2 unsupported inference from B; 3 unresolved/unsupported inference from C; 4 family-account claim in D; 5 unsupported inference from an absence. Accept "unresolved" for 2 or 5 if the explanation identifies the missing evidence.

Assessment rubric, 8 points

Criterion	2 points	1 point	0 points
Source identification	Two sources correctly identified	One source identified	No source identified
Evidence	Two accurate, bounded statements	One accurate statement	Assertions unsupported
Uncertainty	Specific limit and useful next record	Limit stated, next record vague	Certainty claimed without support
Interpretation	Clear distinction between record, inference and memory	Partial distinction	Conflates them

Evaluation and revision protocol

No pilot results are claimed. Invite one teacher to test with one class only after agreement. Suggested success target: at least 75% of participating students score 6/8 or higher; this is a design target, not a reported result. Compare baseline classification and exit response; record class count and anonymized score totals. Do not collect student names, trauma narratives or ancestry. Record image legibility, timing, accessibility barriers and misleading wording. Revise sources/key before claiming classroom readiness. Classroom piloting is a companion use, not the main public audience for the NEH exhibition proposal.

Pilot feedback form

Prototype; no evaluation results yet. No student names or personal family disclosures requested.

Teacher/session code _____ Date _____ Participants _____ Time used _____

Source images readable? yes / partly / no. Which image/line caused difficulty? _____

Was the partial transcription sufficient? _____ Accessibility changes needed? _____

Was the discussion appropriate without graphic detail? _____

Baseline correct classifications ___ / ___; exit correct classifications ___ / ___

Rubric totals: 0–3 ___; 4–5 ___; 6–8 ___; not completed ___

Did students distinguish 2 August attack claim from 10 August death inscription? _____

Misleading wording or unsupported certainty noticed: _____

Most useful source / least useful source and why: _____

Revision, responsible person, target date, and follow-up result: _____